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ROB BONTA

Attorney General

Consumer Complaint Against A Business/Company

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Thank you, your submission has been sent.

A copy of your submission is shown below. **Please use your browser Print function to print this page for your records.**

Please be advised that our office cannot represent individual citizens in legal matters, and cannot give individuals legal advice.

If you need legal assistance, we suggest that you contact a private attorney. You may obtain a referral to a certified lawyer referral service by contacting the State Bar at 866-442-2529 (toll-free in California) or 415-538-2250 (from outside California), or via the State Bar website.

If you cannot afford a private attorney, you may consider contacting your local legal

aid office. For a referral, visit the Legal Services Corporation and click on the Find Legal Aid tab.

If you have information about a crime, please report the matter locally to the police department or sheriff's office. For contact information, visit the California Law Enforcement Agencies page and click on your city or county law enforcement agency.

If you are contacting our Office about the national mortgage servicing settlement with Citibank, JPMorgan Chase/Washington Mutual, Bank of America/Countrywide, Wells Fargo/Wachovia, and Ally Financial/GMAC, please visit our National Mortgage Settlement website for helpful information.

Although we do our best to respond to all e-mails as quickly as possible, due to high volume, it is possible to experience a delay. We thank you for your patience.

PUBLIC INQUIRY UNIT

Data you submitted:

Your Information
First Name Nicolas
Middle Initial
Last Name Hernandez
Address Line [REDACTED]
Address Line 2

City [REDACTED]

State CA

Zip Code 9[REDACTED]

(+4)

Email Address [REDACTED]

Confirm Email Address [REDACTED]

Area Code [REDACTED]

Phone Number [REDACTED]

Are you submitting this complaint on behalf of someone else? No

Business Information (Complaint Against):

Company Name Motorola Mobility LLC

Company Address 222 W. Merchandise Mart Plaza, Suite 1800

Company City Chicago

Company State IL

Zip Code 60654

(+4)

Area Code 866

Phone Number 8618157

Email Address

Website motorola.com

Complaint

Amount in dispute

\$ 29.99

I am filing a complaint against Motorola Mobility LLC regarding a manufacturer-level bootloader restriction on my Moto G Play 2024 (XT2413V, IMEI [REDACTED] 3198) that prevents me from using a legitimate, Motorola-issued unlock key on a fully paid-off, carrier-unlocked device.

On January 24, 2026, I raised this issue on Motorola's official community forum, providing my device's CID and hardware details. Motorola support agents responded that my device was categorically ineligible for bootloader unlocking because it was Tracfone-branded, and that Tracfone-locked devices are excluded from Motorola's unlock program.

Despite that response, on February 12, 2026, Motorola's own Bootloader Unlock Portal verified my IMEI and issued me a valid cryptographic unlock code. When I entered that code via fastboot, the device validated it and advanced to the final unlock warning screen, but then looped back to fastboot instead of completing the unlock — meaning Motorola's own subsequently-issued key cannot execute on my device. My phone's settings confirm OEM Unlocking is enabled and Network Lock status is "Unlocked."

I previously filed a related FCC complaint (Ticket No. 8711384) against TracFone/Straight Talk, my carrier. In that case, TracFone/Straight Talk formally admitted in writing that they do not have the source code or technical ability to clear the factory-level secure-boot partition blocks on this device — meaning responsibility for resolving this lies with Motorola as the manufacturer, not the carrier.

In a written response dated April 22, 2026, Motorola stated that "unlocking a device is up to the carrier" and directed me to Motorola Forums for further steps — despite having already issued me a valid unlock key through their own official portal in February. I subsequently contacted Motorola Executive Customer Relations, who again directed me to the same community forums, which had already failed to resolve the issue.

My phone is fully paid off and confirmed network-unlocked by TracFone. Under the FCC's 2015 unlocking rules and the CTIA voluntary unlocking commitments (to which Motorola/Lenovo is a signatory), manufacturers are expected to ensure that provisioned unlock keys can actually execute on eligible, paid-off devices. Motorola's own conflicting responses — first declaring the device categorically ineligible, then issuing a working key that fails to execute — demonstrate an internal inconsistency in their unlock eligibility system that they have not resolved.

Requested remedy: That Motorola Mobility LLC either (1) issue a software patch or backend whitelist entry allowing my provisioned unlock key to execute, or (2) provide an unbranded retail replacement unit.

Related case reference: FCC Ticket No. 8840957 (previously closed by FCC as outside their jurisdiction, referring me to the state AG)

Supporting documents: Written response letter from Motorola Mobility dated April 22, 2026; unlock code confirmation email dated February 12, 2026; device settings screenshots confirming unlock status and IMEI; Motorola community forum thread dated January 24–25, 2026

Briefly state what you would consider a reasonable resolution from the company

Motorola to issue a software patch or whitelist entry so my unlock key works, or provide a replacement unit.

Have you contacted the company about this issue? Yes

Date of last contact 04/22/2026

Communication means

- E-mail
- Postal mail

Person communicated with Whitney

Results of communication Motorola acknowledged the issue but declined further help, redirecting me to community forums.

Have you previously contacted our Office or other agencies about this issue? Yes

Agencies contacted FCC

Date agency contacted FCC (Ticket No. 8840957)

No

Documents

Do you want to upload supporting documents? Yes

Upload supporting documents gmail-fcc-attorney-general.pdf

Description of document FCC closure notice (Ticket #8840957) referring complaint to State AG.

Do you wish to upload a second supporting document? Yes

Upload second supporting document motorola_letter_original.pdf

Description of second document Motorola's written response (4/22/2026) declining to help and redirecting to forums.

Do you wish to upload a third supporting document? Yes

Upload third supporting document motogplay2024_oem_toggle.pdf

Description of third document Screenshots confirming OEM unlocking enabled and device unlock status/IMEI.

Do you wish to upload a fourth supporting document? Yes

Upload fourth supporting document lenovo_forum_posting.pdf

Description of fourth document Motorola forum thread where agents declared device ineligible for bootloader unlock.

Do you wish to upload a fifth supporting document? Yes

Upload fifth supporting document motorola_portal_key.pdf

Description of fifth document Motorola email confirming issuance of bootloader unlock code via official portal.

Additional Information About You (optional)

Are you 65 years or older? No

Do you have a disability? No

What is your annual household income? [REDACTED]

Are you a current member of the U.S. Armed Forces or the immediate family of a service member?

No

Are you a former member of the U.S. Armed Forces? No

Do you have limited English ability? No

Statement

I affirm that the foregoing information is true and accurate Yes

By filing this complaint, I authorize you to send this complaint to the party named, and for that party to communicate, including disclosure of non-public personal information, with the Attorney General's office concerning this complaint.

Yes

Attorney General's Role

[Return to the Comment form](#)

